

Forrest Owens

PHD CANDIDATE · POLITICAL SCIENCE

Kerr Hall 568 1 Shields Avenue, Davis CA 95616

✉ flowens@ucdavis.edu

Education

University of California, Davis

PHD POLITICAL SCIENCE

Davis, CA

2021-present

- Major Field: International Relations
- Subfield: Comparative Politics
- Areas of Interest: Climate Change Politics, International Political Economy, Democratization, Public Opinion, Foreign Aid
- Major Advisor: Gabriella Montinola

College of William & Mary

BA PUBLIC POLICY *with honors*

Williamsburg, VA

2014-2018

- Minor in Hispanic Studies
- Undergraduate Research Advisor: Dan Maliniak

Professional Experience

2025-
present

Pre-doctoral Fellow, Global Climate Policy lab, Stanford University

2021-2023;
2024-2025

Graduate Teaching Assistant, University of California, Davis

2022-2024

Graduate Student Researcher, Environmental Science and Policy, University of California, Davis

2022-2022

Special Researcher for Environment and Energy, Shapiro-Davis Pennsylvania Gubernatorial Transition Team

2021-2021

Senior Research Associate, Breakwater Strategy

2020-2021

Research Manager, WBA Research

2018-2020

Data Reporting Specialist, TargetSmart Communications

Research

WORKING PAPERS

Owens, F., Verley, D., Constantino, C., De la Cuesta, B., Kennard, A. Automated Survey Harmonization via Source-Consistent Entity Resolution.

Owens, F., Climate Shocks and Protest in Nigeria

Owens, F., De la Cuesta, B. Competitive Climate: Climate Shocks and the Strategic Expansion of Vote buying in Africa.

Owens, F., Green Aid and Chinese Soft Power in Africa.

Owens, F., Montinola, G. Rewarding Ambitious Climate Pledges.

CONFERENCE PAPERS

Owens, F., de la Cuesta, B. De la Cuesta, B. Competitive Climate: Climate Shocks and the Strategic Expansion of Vote buying in Africa. Presented at the American Political Science Association Conference. 2025.

Owens, F., Green Aid and Chinese Soft Power in Africa. Presented at the American Political Science Association Conference. 2024.

Owens, F., Green Aid and Chinese Soft Power in Africa. Presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference. 2024.

Owens, F., Montinola, G. Rewarding Ambitious Climate Pledges. Presented at the Western Political Science Association Conference. 2023.

Owens, F., Parajon, E. Climate Change, Sea Level Rise, and City Preparation. Presented at the Midwest Political Science Association Conference. 2018.

Awards, Fellowships, & Grants

2026	Dean's Graduate Summer Support Award , University of California, Davis	\$ 6,000
2025	Pre-doctoral Fellowship , Stanford University	\$ 63,000
2025	Faculty-Graduate Student Summer Collaborative , University of California, Davis	\$ 5,000
2025	Living Expense Fellowship , University of California, Davis	\$ 3,000
2024	APSA Travel Grant , University of California, Davis	\$ 1,000
2023	Conference Travel Grant , University of California, Davis	\$ 1,000
2022	Faculty-Graduate Student Summer Collaborative , University of California, Davis	\$ 5,000
2018	Undergraduate Travel Grant , College of William & Mary	\$ 500

Teaching Experience

Spring 2025	Intro to International Relations , Teaching Assistant and Section Leader	<i>UC Davis</i>
Winter 2025	Intro to International Relations , Teaching Assistant and Section Leader	<i>UC Davis</i>
Fall 2024	Scientific Study of War , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Summer 2024	Mass Media & Politics , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Winter 2023	International Law , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Fall 2022	Global Inequality , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Spring 2022	Politics and Inequality , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>
Winter 2022	Politics of Sports , Teaching Assistant	<i>UC Davis</i>

Mentoring

2021-2022 **Kieran Cabezas**, Student, UC Davis

Languages

Native: English **Fluent:** Spanish

References

Gabriella Montinola, Professor, UC Davis grmontinola@ucdavis.edu

Lauren Peritz, Associate Professor, UC Davis lperitz@ucdavis.edu

Daniel (Yuch) Kono, Professor Emeritus, UC Davis dykono@ucdavis.edu

Brandon de la Cuesta, Research Scientist, Stanford University brandon.delacuesta@stanford.edu